Options that Determine What Ruby Runs

-0[octal]

The 0 flag (the digit zero) specifies the record separator character (\0, if no digit follows). -00 indicates paragraph mode: records are separated by two successive default record separator characters. 0777 reads the entire file at once (because it is an illegal character). Sets $/.

-a

Autosplit mode when used with -n or -p; equivalent to executing $F = $_.split at the top of each loop iteration.

-c

Checks syntax only; does not execute the program.

--copyright

Prints the copyright notice and exits.

-e 'command'

Executes *command* as one line of Ruby source. Several -e's are allowed, and the commands are treated as multiple lines in the same program. If *programfile* is omitted when -e is present, execution stops after the -e commands have been run. Programs run using -e have access to older behavior of ranges and regular expressions in conditions—ranges of integers compare against the current input line number, and regular expressions match against $_.

-F pattern

Specifies the input field separator ($;) used as the default for split (affects the -a option).

-h, --help

Displays a short help screen.

-l

Enables automatic line-ending processing; sets $\ to the value of $/ and chops every input line automatically.

-n

Assumes a while gets; ...; end loop around your program. For example, a simple grep command could be implemented as follows:

```
$ ruby -n -e "print if /wombat/"  *.txt
```

-p

Places your program code within the loop while gets; ...; print; end.

```
$ ruby -p -e "$_.downcase!" *.txt
```

--version

Displays the Ruby version number and exits.